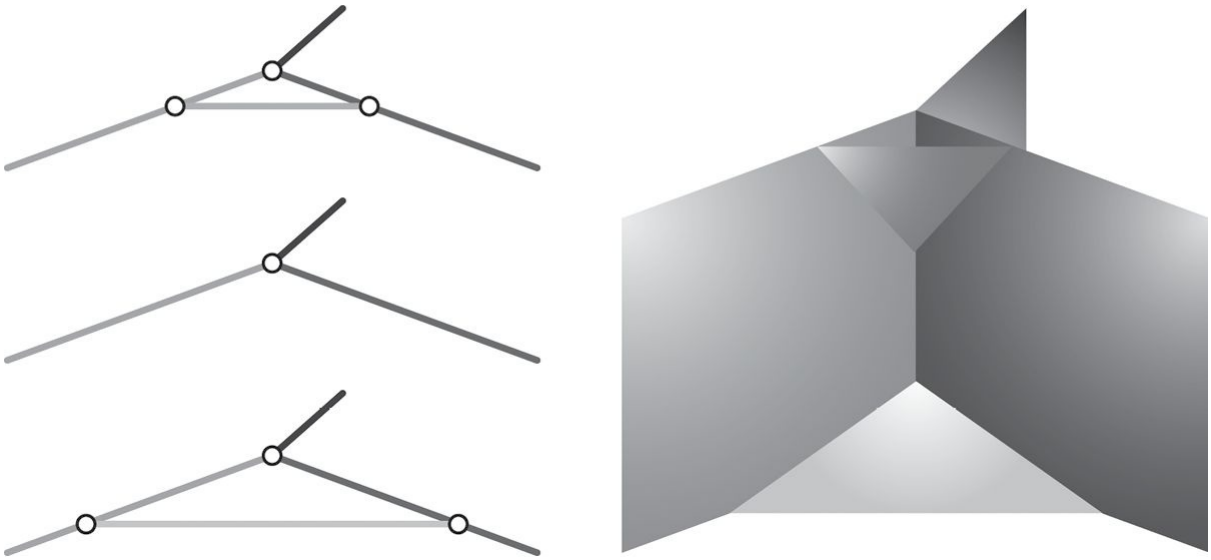


Figure 7.2 An evolving spin-network: three nodes combine into a single node, and then separate again. On the right, the spinfoam representing this process.

The image portrayed on the right of figure 7.2 is a ‘spinfoam’. ‘Foam’ because it is made of surfaces which meet on lines, which in turn meet on vertices, resembling a foam of soap bubbles (figure 7.3). ‘*Spin*foam’ because the faces of the foam carry spins, as do the links of the graphs whose evolution they describe.



Figure 7.3 The foam of soap bubbles.